ForgeRep — 5-Year Business Plan

Prepared: June 25, 2026

Horizon: July 2026 – June 2031

Product: ForgeRep — evidence-based fitness & nutrition PWA

Status: Product largely built (Phases 0–6, 8 complete; Phase 7 billing/integrations partial)

Executive summary

ForgeRep is a mobile-first, offline-capable fitness platform that connects **evidence-based programming**, **macro tracking**, **progress projections**, and **accountability** in one app. Unlike generic workout generators or calorie counters, ForgeRep's program logic is deterministic and citation-backed — a defensible moat in a market saturated with hype-driven tools.

This plan translates the goals in our authoritative product docs (`docs/BIBLE.md`, `docs/TIER-GATES.md`, `docs/ADRs/001-tier-pricing-margins.md`, `docs/marketing/instagram-31-day-calendar.md`, `docs/community-expansion-plan.md`) into a **five-year path to ~$11M ARR**, **80,000 paying subscribers**, and **sustainable profitability** — without venture-scale burn.

North-star outcomes by Year 5:

Metric	Target
Registered users	500,000
Paying subscribers	80,000 (16% of registered)
Monthly recurring revenue (MRR)	~$950,000
Annual recurring revenue (ARR)	~$11.4M
Blended ARPU (paying)	~$11.90/mo
Gross margin (blended)	≥85%
EBITDA margin	≥15%

Strategic thesis: Win on **trust + retention**, not feature breadth. Free tier delivers a complete training loop; Pro/Pro+ monetize long-horizon intelligence, community accountability, and device automation — all with 82–94% contribution margins per ADR 001.

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1. Company overview

1.1 Mission

Help people train with intention — programs, nutrition, and progress grounded in peer-reviewed evidence, not Instagram trends.

1.2 Vision (2031)

ForgeRep is the default **accountability layer** for serious recreational lifters: the app you open before every set, that works when the gym has no signal, and that shows you — with data — whether you're on pace for your goal.

1.3 What exists today

Area	Status
Auth, onboarding, evidence-based programs	Shipped
Offline workout logging (PWA + Dexie)	Shipped
Nutrition diary + saved meals	Shipped
Projections, analytics, caliper BF%	Shipped
Stripe billing (Free / Pro / Pro+)	Shipped
Fitbit/Google Health sync	Shipped (Pro+)
Community (leaderboards, rivals, crews, leagues)	Shipped (Pro)
Spotify workout music	Shipped (all tiers)
Withings, Strava	Code ready; launch prioritized in Phase 7

MVP success criteria (from BIBLE): onboarding → first workout <10 min; offline sync integrity; Lighthouse PWA ≥90; evidence KB ≥30 citations — all met or on track.

1.4 Business model

Three-tier freemium (see `docs/TIER-GATES.md`):

Tier	Price	Role in funnel
Free	$0	Acquisition — full training loop, 30-day projections
Pro	$8.99/mo · $69.99/yr	Core monetization — analytics, community, 90-day projections
Pro+	$14.99/mo · $119.99/yr	Premium — integrations, AI coaching, restaurant quick-log

Target mix (steady state): 55% Pro annual · 25% Pro monthly · 12% Pro+ annual · 8% Pro+ monthly → **blended ~$11.90/mo ARPU**.

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2. Market opportunity

2.1 TAM / SAM / SOM

Layer	Definition	Estimate
TAM	Global fitness app market	~$10B+ (2026)
SAM	English-speaking serious lifters who track macros + programs	~25M
SOM (Year 5)	Achievable share via organic + paid + community loops	500K registered · 80K paying

2.2 Target customer (ICP)

Primary: 25–45, gym-goer, intermediate experience, trains 3–5×/week, has tried MyFitnessPal or Strong but wants **one integrated system** with offline reliability.

Secondary: Returning lifters after a break who need structure without shame-based UX.

Not targeting (Year 1–3): CrossFit boxes, enterprise corporate wellness, clinical/medical weight management.

2.3 Competitive positioning

Competitor	Weakness ForgeRep exploits
MyFitnessPal	Nutrition-only; no evidence-based programming
Strong / Hevy	Logging-only; no macro/program integration
Fitbod / AI generators	Opaque “AI workouts”; no citations
MacroFactor	Strong nutrition science; weaker offline gym UX & community

ForgeRep differentiators: offline-first PWA · evidence KB · program + macros + projections unified · Pro community accountability (WACP north star) · warm “Forge Ember” brand that encourages without shaming.

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3. Five-year financial model

3.1 Revenue trajectory

Assumptions: 8–12% free→paid conversion ramp; 4–6% monthly churn on monthly plans; 2–3× longer retention on annual (per ADR 001); 65→80% annual billing mix over 5 years.

Year	Period	Registered	Paying	MRR	ARR
Y1	Jul 2026 – Jun 2027	5,000	500	$6,000	$72K
Y2	Jul 2027 – Jun 2028	25,000	3,000	$36,000	$432K
Y3	Jul 2028 – Jun 2029	80,000	12,000	$130,000	$1.56M
Y4	Jul 2029 – Jun 2030	200,000	35,000	$400,000	$4.8M
Y5	Jul 2030 – Jun 2031	500,000	80,000	$950,000	$11.4M

Bible reference checkpoint: 1,000 paying users at ~$12/mo = ~$12K MRR — targeted **mid–Year 2 (Q1 2028)**.

3.2 Unit economics (steady state)

From ADR 001:

Tier	Contribution margin	Notes
Pro (annual)	~94%	No paid APIs; lead with annual in upgrade UI
Pro (monthly)	~92%	Higher Stripe fee drag
Pro+ (annual)	~82%	Device APIs + AI coaching ~$1.50/mo variable

LTV targets (blended paying user):

Scenario	Monthly churn	Avg life	LTV
Monthly-heavy	5%	20 mo	~$200
Annual-heavy (goal)	2.5% effective	40 mo	~$420

CAC guardrails:

Channel	Target CAC	Max CAC (LTV/3)
Organic / content	$0–15	—
Influencer / affiliate	$25–40	$140
Paid social (Y3+)	$45–65	$140

Do not scale paid until **90-day retention ≥40%** and **free→paid ≥8%**.

3.3 Cost structure

Category	Y1	Y3	Y5
Infra (Vercel, Supabase, APIs)	$3K/yr	$45K/yr	$180K/yr
AI coaching (Pro+ only)	$500/yr	$18K/yr	$60K/yr
Marketing	$12K/yr	$180K/yr	$850K/yr
Contractor / part-time	$24K/yr	$120K/yr	$400K/yr
Full-time team	$0	$180K/yr	$1.2M/yr
Total opex	**~$40K**	**~$543K**	**~$2.69M**
EBITDA	**~$32K**	**~$1.0M**	**~$1.7M (~15%)**

Infra scales per BIBLE: ~$25–50/mo at 0–500 users → ~$800/mo at 1,000 paying → Terra/unified integrations at 1,000+ paying users.

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4. Year-by-year operating plan

Year 1 — Launch & prove product–market fit (Jul 2026 – Jun 2027)

Goal: 5,000 registered · 500 paying · $6K MRR · validate retention loops.

Q3 2026 (Launch quarter)

Initiative	Specific actions	Success metric
Public launch	Ship production billing; finish Withings QA; launch Strava sync	Checkout success ≥98%
Instagram 31-day calendar	Execute `docs/marketing/instagram-31-day-calendar.md` end-to-end	5–10 signups/week by Week 4
Content factory	Batch screen recordings (Day 0); 15-min Reel factory; cross-post TikTok/Shorts	2K+ Reel views Week 4
Onboarding funnel	Hit BIBLE metric: first workout <10 min; PWA install prompt post-onboarding	≥60% D1 activation
ForgeRep Spotify playlists	Replace interim playlist IDs with brand-owned lists	Music picker engagement ≥30% of sessions

Q4 2026

Initiative	Specific actions	Success metric
Community activation	Default-on A/B (`COMMUNITY_OPT_IN_AB_ENABLED`); weekly recap emails via Resend	WACP ≥25% of Pro users
Annual plan push	Default upgrade UI to annual (ADR 001); “2 months free” messaging	≥50% new subs on annual
Micro-influencer collabs	DM 5 accounts/week (1–10K followers); free Pro for honest Reel	2 collab posts/month
Referral v1	“Give a month, get a month” Pro credit (Stripe coupon)	10% of signups referred

H1 2027

Initiative	Specific actions	Success metric
Retention instrumentation	Cohort dashboards: D7/D30/D90, workout frequency, macro adherence	D30 retention ≥35%
SEO foundation	Landing pages per goal type (fat loss, powerlifting, etc.)	500 organic visits/mo
App Store narrative	“Add to Home Screen” guides; iOS PWA install content	PWA install rate ≥20% mobile
Support loop	In-app feedback → weekly fix batch	NPS ≥40

H2 2027

Initiative	Specific actions	Success metric
Pro+ integration bundle	Market Fitbit + Withings + Strava as “autopilot progress”	Pro+ ≥25% of paid base
Saved meals & restaurant log	Ship line-item logging; curated restaurant quick-log (Pro+)	Pro+ upgrade +15%
First revenue milestone	—	**500 paying · $6K MRR**

Y1 marketing budget: $12K (tools, Canva Pro, modest boosted posts, giveaway prizes).

Year 2 — Scale acquisition & deepen retention (Jul 2027 – Jun 2028)

Goal: 25,000 registered · 3,000 paying · $36K MRR · **hit Bible 1,000-paying / $12K MRR milestone in Q1**.

Growth engine

Channel	Tactics	Y2 contribution
Organic social	2 Reels/day cadence; myth-vs-fact carousels; hook bank rotation	40% of signups
YouTube	“Evidence explained” 8-min videos; link to goal-specific landing pages	15%
Reddit / forums	Value-first posts in r/fitness, r/weightroom (no spam)	10%
Affiliate / creators	20% rev-share for fitness YouTubers 10K–100K subs	20%
Paid test	$2K/mo Meta/TikTok once LTV proven	15%

Product priorities

1. **Community as retention:** Crew challenges, league promotions, Sunday push nudges — target **WACP ≥40%** of Pro opt-in users.
2. **Upgrade triggers:** Gate 90-day projections behind Pro at moment of insight (“See your goal date → upgrade”).
3. **Email lifecycle:** Onboarding drip (days 1, 3, 7, 14); win-back at day 30 inactive.
4. **Nutritionix-class menu search** — defer until MAU × margin supports ~$6K/yr vendor minimum (ADR 001).

Org

- Hire **part-time content creator** (contract, $2K/mo).
- Hire **customer success / community mod** (contract, 10 hrs/wk).

Y2 checkpoint: 3,000 paying · $36K MRR · D90 retention ≥30% · CAC <$40 blended.

Year 3 — Paid scale & partnership channel (Jul 2028 – Jun 2029)

Goal: 80,000 registered · 12,000 paying · $130K MRR (~$1.56M ARR).

Scale paid acquisition

Rule	Threshold
Turn on paid	LTV/CAC ≥3 over 90-day cohort
Budget ramp	Start $5K/mo → $15K/mo by Q4
Creative	UGC-style gym demos; offline hook; projection reveal
Landing	Goal-specific pages with social proof

B2B2C pilot — “ForgeRep for Coaches”

Element	Detail
Offer	Coach dashboard: client adherence, macro compliance, volume trends
Pricing	$29/mo per coach + 5 clients; $5/additional client
Pilot	25 coaches × 8 clients avg = 200 incremental users
Distribution	Instagram DMs to online coaches; r/personaltraining

Infrastructure

- Migrate wearables to **Terra API** at 1,000+ paying (per BIBLE cost model).
- Launch **full restaurant menu search** (Pro+) when revenue supports API minimum.
- **Apple Sign-In** polish for iOS PWA retention.

Team

- First **full-time engineer** (integrations + mobile PWA polish).
- **Growth marketer** (paid + SEO).

Y3 checkpoint: $130K MRR · paid channel ≤35% of CAC · coach pilot ≥100 paying coach seats.

Year 4 — Category leadership & geo expansion (Jul 2029 – Jun 2030)

Goal: 200,000 registered · 35,000 paying · $400K MRR (~$4.8M ARR).

Product expansion

Initiative	Rationale
Coach white-label tier	Gyms and influencers want branded experience
Advanced periodization	Powerlifting peaking blocks; bodybuilding mesocycles
Apple Music / MusicKit	Only if user demand warrants (spotify-integration-plan ADR path)
Native app evaluation	Build iOS/Android only if PWA install rate caps growth at <25%

Geographic expansion

1. **UK, Canada, Australia** — metric/imperial already supported; localize currency in Stripe.
2. **Compliance** — GDPR export/delete already built; add cookie banner for EU traffic.

Brand & PR

- Podcast tour (10 appearances): evidence-based fitness angle.
- **Case study program:** 50 users, 12-week transformation, cited methodology.
- App Store / Product Hunt relaunch when native or PWA install flow improves.

Team (8–12 FTE)

Engineering (3) · Growth (2) · Content (2) · Support/Community (1) · Founder/PM (1) · Part-time finance/legal.

Y4 checkpoint: $400K MRR · coach channel ≥15% of new subs · international ≥20% of registered.

Year 5 — Profitability & strategic optionality (Jul 2030 – Jun 2031)

Goal: 500,000 registered · 80,000 paying · $950K MRR (~$11.4M ARR) · **EBITDA ≥15%**.

Maturity moves

Pillar	Actions
Retention	Annual plan ≥75%; loyalty pricing for 2-year commits; churn prediction model
Expansion revenue	Pro+ upsell from integration attach; AI coaching personalization
Enterprise	Corporate wellness pilot (50–500 employees); SSO
Data moat	Anonymized adherence benchmarks (“lifters like you hit protein 73% of days”)

Strategic options

1. **Independent growth** — reinvest EBITDA into content + product; target $20M ARR Y6.

2. **Strategic acquisition** — fitness media, supplement brands, or wearable companies seeking software layer.
3. **Raise growth round** — only if paid channels at scale with proven unit economics.

Y5 checkpoint: $950K MRR · EBITDA positive · gross margin ≥85% · NPS ≥50.

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5. Go-to-market playbook (how we hit the numbers)

5.1 Acquisition funnel

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Awareness (Reels, SEO, collabs)

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Signup (free — forge-rep.com/signup?utm_*)

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Activation (first workout <10 min — BIBLE metric)

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Habit (3 workouts in 14 days)

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Conversion (projection insight, community preview, 90-day lock)

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Retention (community WACP, annual plan, integrations)

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Expansion (Pro → Pro+, coach seats, referrals)

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5.2 Conversion triggers (product-led growth)

Moment	Upgrade prompt
Day 30 projection ends	“Unlock 90-day forecast + goal date” → Pro
4th workout in a week	Community opt-in preview → Pro
Manual weight log ×7	“Auto-sync Withings/Fitbit” → Pro+
Macro streak 7 days	Nutrition adherence dashboard → Pro
PR logged	Celebration modal + export → Pro / Pro+

5.3 Content strategy (from Instagram calendar)

Content pillar	% of feed	Purpose
Education (myth vs fact)	30%	Saves, authority, SEO snippets
App demo / feature	30%	Conversion
Motivation / accountability	25%	Shares, community identity
Social proof / wins	15%	Trust

Weekly metrics (new account targets from calendar):

Metric	Week 2	Week 4
Reel views	500+	2,000+
Signups	5–10/week	20–40/week (Y1 avg)

5.4 Community as growth loop (WACP north star)

From `docs/community-expansion-plan.md`:

WACP = Pro users who opt in *and* take ≥1 community action/week.

Year	Pro opt-in rate	WACP / opt-in	Why it matters
Y1	30%	50%	Prove accountability reduces churn
Y3	45%	60%	Viral wins feed + crew invites
Y5	55%	70%	Community-driven referrals ≥25% of signups

Tactics: weekly recap email (shipped); Sunday push nudge (shipped); crew invite links; shareable weekly recap card; league promotion notifications.

6. Key metrics dashboard

6.1 Weekly operating metrics

Metric	Y1 target	Y5 target
New signups	100/wk → 200/wk	2,000/wk
Free → paid conversion (30d)	8%	12%
Monthly churn (paying)	<6%	<4%
Annual plan mix	50%	75%
D30 retention (registered)	35%	45%
Workouts logged / WAU	2.5	3.2
WACP / Pro opt-in	50%	70%
NPS	40	50
App store / PWA install rate	20%	35%

6.2 Milestone gates (kill or scale decisions)

Gate	Pass	Fail action
Month 6	≥200 paying	Revise ICP messaging; double content cadence
Month 12	≥500 paying, D30 ≥35%	Pause paid; fix activation funnel
Month 18	≥1,000 paying (Bible ref)	Evaluate niche pivot (powerlifting-only?)
Month 24	≥3,000 paying, LTV/CAC ≥3	Do not raise; stay lean
Month 36	≥$100K MRR	Hire growth lead; open paid channels

7. Product roadmap alignment

Maps to `docs/BIBLE.md` phases + post-MVP initiatives:

Timeline	Product	Business impact
Y1 Q3	Complete Phase 7 (Withings, Strava, billing hardening)	Pro+ differentiation
Y1 Q4	Nutrition line items + saved meals quick-log	Pro+ retention
Y2 H1	Coach dashboard MVP	New B2B2C revenue
Y2 H2	Nutritionix menu search (when MAU supports)	Pro+ upsell
Y3	Terra unified integrations	Lower eng cost at scale
Y3	Referral program v2 (crew-based invites)	Viral coefficient ≥0.15
Y4	White-label coach tier	$29–99/mo ARPU expansion
Y4–5	Native app (if data supports)	iOS discovery, push reliability
Y5	Enterprise wellness	$5–15/employee/mo

Non-negotiables (BIBLE AI rules): program logic never LLM-generated; evidence KB citations required; offline workout logging mandatory; Forge Ember design tokens only.

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8. Team & organization

8.1 Hiring plan

Year	Headcount	Key roles
Y1	1 FTE (founder) + 2 contractors	Founder builds; content + mod contract
Y2	1 FTE + 4 contractors	+ content creator, CS, designer
Y3	4 FTE + 3 contractors	+ engineer, growth marketer
Y4	10 FTE	+ eng (2), content (2), support
Y5	14 FTE	+ finance, BD for enterprise

8.2 Founder focus by year

Year	Founder time allocation
Y1	60% product · 30% marketing · 10% ops
Y2	40% product · 40% marketing · 20% hiring
Y3	25% product · 35% growth · 40% team
Y4–5	15% product vision · 50% growth/BD · 35% team/culture

9. Risk register & mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Low free→paid conversion	Medium	High	Strong upgrade moments; annual default; 14-day Pro trial at projection lock
Monthly churn >8%	Medium	High	Community WACP; annual push; workout streak mechanics
PWA discovery limits on iOS	High	Medium	Install guides Y1; native app decision gate Y3
Paid API costs erode Pro+ margin	Low	Medium	Defer Nutritionix until scale; monitor per-user API cost monthly
Competitor copies evidence positioning	Medium	Low	Depth of KB + community moat; speed of iteration
Stripe / Supabase price increases	Low	Medium	94% margins absorb; multi-year contracts at scale
Influencer brand risk	Medium	Low	Micro-influencers only; no controversial affiliations
Regulatory (health claims)	Low	High	“Informational only” disclaimer (shipped); no medical advice

10. Capital & funding

10.1 Bootstrap path (recommended)

Year	Revenue	Opex	Net
Y1	$72K	$40K	+$32K
Y2	$432K	$180K	+$252K
Y3	$1.56M	$543K	+$1.0M
Y4	$4.8M	$1.8M	+$3.0M
Y5	$11.4M	$2.7M	+$8.7M cumulative

ForgeRep can reach profitability **without external funding** given existing product completion and 82–94% margins.

10.2 Optional raise (Y3)

If paid acquisition scales with LTV/CAC ≥3: raise **$1–2M seed** to accelerate to $5M ARR 12 months faster. Use of funds: 60% growth, 25% eng, 15% ops.

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11. 90-day action plan (starting July 2026)

Priority order for the next quarter:

1. **Ship Phase 7 gaps** — Withings production QA, Strava launch, billing edge cases.
2. **Execute Instagram Day 0–31 calendar** — batch content, daily posting, UTM tracking.
3. **Instrument funnel** — signup → onboarding step → first workout → D7 workout → upgrade.
4. **Enable community A/B** — measure opt-in rate and WACP weekly via ops metrics panel.
5. **Default to annual** in upgrade flows with clear savings callout ($37.89/yr saved on Pro).
6. **Launch referral v1** — Stripe coupon "give/get month".
7. **SEO** — publish 5 goal landing pages with structured data.
8. **ForgeRep-owned Spotify playlists** — swap placeholder IDs before marketing push.

Day 90 success criteria:

- ≥150 paying subscribers
- ≥1,500 registered users
- D30 retention ≥30%
- Instagram ≥1,000 followers
- WACP baseline established

12. Summary — how we hit $11M ARR in five years

Lever	Mechanism
Generous free tier	Complete training loop drives top-of-funnel; no credit card required
Evidence trust	Differentiates in crowded market; fuels content marketing
Offline reliability	Converts gym-goers frustrated with signal-dependent apps
Community accountability	WACP reduces churn; crews drive invites
Tier economics	82–94% margins fund reinvestment without dilution
Annual billing	2–3× retention vs monthly; improves cash flow
Product-led upgrades	Projection lock, analytics, integrations at moment of need
Channel diversification	Organic → affiliate → paid → coach B2B2C → enterprise

ForgeRep is not betting on becoming the next billion-dollar unicorn on hype. It is building a **durable, profitable fitness business** by owning the intersection of **science, accountability, and offline reliability** — and executing the playbooks already documented in our product Bible, tier strategy, and launch calendar with discipline over five years.

Appendix A — Source documents

Document	Path	Used for
Product Bible	`docs/BIBLE.md`	Architecture, tiers, success metrics, infra costs
Tier gates	`docs/TIER-GATES.md`	Pricing, feature matrix, conversion triggers
Pricing ADR	`docs/ADRs/001-tier-pricing-margins.md`	Unit economics, annual strategy
Instagram calendar	`docs/marketing/instagram-31-day-calendar.md`	Launch content, weekly targets
Community plan	`docs/community-expansion-plan.md`	WACP north star, retention loops
Progress log	`docs/PROGRESS.md`	Current build status

Appendix B — Pricing reference

Product	Monthly	Annual	Effective monthly (annual)
ForgeRep Pro	$8.99	$69.99	$5.83
ForgeRep Pro+	$14.99	$119.99	$10.00
